COMPANY POLICY MANUAL

ABC Life Sciences Pvt. Ltd.

Employee Conduct, Workplace, Information Security and Operational Policies

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Policy Owner: Human Resources & Corporate Compliance

Review Cycle: Annual or when material regulatory/business changes occur

Purpose

This policy manual establishes common standards for employee conduct, attendance, information security, confidentiality, workplace safety, quality, procurement, travel, and grievance handling. It applies to all permanent employees, probationers, consultants, trainees, interns, and other personnel working on behalf of ABC Life Sciences Pvt. Ltd., unless a written contract or local law provides a different requirement.

How to use this document

Employees are expected to understand the policies relevant to their role and follow the procedures communicated by the company. Where two requirements appear to conflict, employees should pause the activity and consult their manager, Human Resources, Quality, Compliance, or Information Security as appropriate.

Key principle

The company expects decisions to be based on safety, integrity, documented requirements, applicable law, quality standards, customer commitments, and protection of company information and assets.

Confidentiality notice: This training document is fictional and created for technical practice with document ingestion, RAG, vector databases, and semantic search. It is not a real corporate policy.

1. Code of Conduct

1.1 Professional behavior

Employees must conduct themselves professionally and respectfully. Harassment, bullying, intimidation, discrimination, retaliation, threats, violence, deliberate falsification of records, and dishonest business practices are prohibited. Employees must communicate respectfully with colleagues, customers, suppliers, candidates, and other stakeholders.

1.2 Conflict of interest

Employees must disclose any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest that could influence a business decision. Examples include participating in a hiring decision involving a close relative, accepting a financial benefit from a supplier, or using confidential company information to support a personal business interest.

1.3 Gifts and hospitality

Employees may accept or offer modest business courtesies only when they are lawful, reasonable, infrequent, transparent, and not intended to influence a business decision. Cash, cash equivalents, personal loans, or benefits that create an obligation must not be accepted. Any gift or hospitality above the company-approved threshold must be disclosed to the employee's manager and Compliance before acceptance.

1.4 Anti-bribery

The company prohibits bribery, kickbacks, facilitation payments, and improper advantages. Employees must not make payments to public officials or commercial representatives to obtain an unfair business benefit. Suspected violations must be reported promptly to Compliance or through the confidential reporting channel.

1.5 Use of company resources

Company property, systems, accounts, software, vehicles, equipment, and funds must be used primarily for legitimate business purposes. Limited personal use may be permitted where it does not create cost, security, productivity, legal, or reputational risk.

Employee responsibilities

- Read and follow policies applicable to your role.
- Protect company property and information.
- Declare conflicts of interest promptly.
- Cooperate with investigations and audits.
- Report suspected misconduct without attempting to conceal evidence.

2. Attendance, Working Hours and Leave

2.1 Working hours

Standard working hours are determined by the employee's function, location, and employment terms. Employees must follow the attendance system designated by the company. Managers are responsible for ensuring that working-hour arrangements are communicated clearly and comply with applicable legal requirements.

2.2 Attendance recording

Employees must record attendance accurately. Proxy attendance, falsifying timesheets, sharing attendance credentials, or asking another person to record attendance on one's behalf is prohibited. Corrections to attendance records must be supported by a legitimate reason and approved according to the attendance procedure.

2.3 Leave application

Planned leave should normally be requested through the HR or attendance system before the leave begins. Emergency or unplanned absence should be communicated to the reporting manager as soon as reasonably possible. Approval depends on leave eligibility, available balance, business requirements, and applicable law.

2.4 Remote and hybrid work

Where remote or hybrid work is approved, employees remain responsible for working hours, availability, confidentiality, information security, and deliverables. Sensitive company documents must not be accessed from unsecured public computers or shared with unauthorized persons.

2.5 Overtime and additional work

Overtime, weekend work, or work on designated holidays must follow the approval process applicable to the employee's location and role. Employees should not routinely work excessive hours without discussing workload and priorities with their manager.

Manager responsibilities

- Set clear expectations for working hours and availability.
- Approve or reject leave requests consistently and document exceptions.
- Monitor workload and escalate recurring capacity issues.
- Ensure attendance records are accurate and corrected through approved processes.

3. Information Security and Data Protection

3.1 Password and authentication

Employees must use unique passwords for company accounts and must not share passwords or authentication codes. Multi-factor authentication must be enabled where required. Passwords must not be stored in plain text, sent through ordinary email, or written where unauthorized persons can access them.

3.2 Confidential information

Confidential information includes customer information, employee records, candidate data, pricing, contracts, business plans, source code, credentials, technical specifications, quality records, and non-public financial information. Employees may access confidential information only when required for their role.

3.3 Data classification

Information should be treated according to its sensitivity. Public information may be shared externally when authorized. Internal information is intended for employees and approved partners. Confidential information requires controlled access. Highly restricted information requires explicit authorization and enhanced safeguards.

3.4 Phishing and suspicious activity

Employees must verify unexpected requests for passwords, payment changes, confidential files, or urgent transfers of information. Suspicious emails, links, attachments, login prompts, or unusual system behavior must be reported to Information Security promptly.

3.5 Lost or stolen devices

Loss or theft of a company device, access card, storage media, or mobile device containing company information must be reported immediately. Employees must not attempt to conceal a security incident because delayed reporting can increase the potential impact.

3.6 AI and external tools

Employees must not enter confidential, personal, customer, regulated, or proprietary information into public AI tools or external software unless the tool and use case have been approved by the company. Generated content must be reviewed for accuracy, confidentiality, intellectual property, and compliance risks before business use.

Security rule of thumb

If you would not send the information to an unknown external recipient, do not paste it into an unapproved external service.

4. Workplace Safety, Quality and Compliance

4.1 Safety responsibilities

Employees must follow site-specific safety procedures, use required personal protective equipment, maintain clear emergency routes, and report unsafe conditions. No employee should knowingly bypass a safety control to save time or meet a target.

4.2 Incident and near-miss reporting

Workplace injuries, environmental incidents, equipment damage, unsafe conditions, and near misses must be reported through the designated reporting process. A near miss is an event that could have caused harm or loss but did not. Reporting near misses supports preventive action.

4.3 Quality records

Quality-related records must be accurate, complete, legible, attributable, and created at the time the activity is performed. Employees must not backdate records, destroy original evidence, or make undocumented changes to controlled records.

4.4 Deviations and corrective actions

A deviation is a departure from an approved procedure, specification, instruction, or expected condition. Employees must document deviations promptly and provide factual information for investigation. Corrective and preventive actions should address the identified root cause rather than only treating the immediate symptom.

4.5 Training

Employees must complete mandatory induction, compliance, safety, information security, and role-specific training within the assigned timelines. Managers must not assign employees to activities requiring qualification or training that the employee has not completed unless a documented supervised-training arrangement is authorized.

4.6 Audit cooperation

Employees must provide accurate information during internal or external audits and must not conceal records or coach another person to provide misleading information. Questions outside an employee's responsibility should be escalated to the appropriate subject-matter owner.

Escalation principle

When an employee identifies a potential safety, quality, regulatory, or data-integrity risk, the expected action is to stop or contain the affected activity where appropriate and escalate the issue through the defined process.

5. Procurement, Expenses and Company Assets

5.1 Procurement

Purchases must follow the approved procurement process. Employees must not split a purchase into smaller transactions to avoid approval thresholds. Supplier selection should consider business need, quality, service, commercial terms, compliance requirements, and conflicts of interest.

5.2 Supplier due diligence

New suppliers may be subject to identity verification, tax documentation, banking verification, quality assessment, compliance screening, and other due-diligence checks appropriate to the supplier and category. Employees must not instruct suppliers to bypass required controls.

5.3 Business expenses

Business expenses must be reasonable, necessary, supported by valid documentation, and submitted within the applicable claim period. Personal expenses must not be disguised as business expenses. Where a receipt is unavailable, the employee must follow the company's approved exception process rather than creating substitute evidence.

5.4 Corporate cards

Corporate cards are issued for authorized business expenditure only. Cardholders are responsible for safeguarding the card, reviewing transactions, submitting supporting documents, and reporting unauthorized transactions immediately.

5.5 Company assets

Laptops, mobile devices, equipment, furniture, access cards, software licenses, and other company assets must be protected from loss, misuse, unauthorized transfer, or damage. Assets must be returned when requested or when employment or assignment ends.

Approval matrix

Activity	Typical Approval Owner	Required Evidence
Routine office purchase	Department Manager	Purchase request / invoice
High-value purchase	Department + Finance	Quotation + approval
New supplier	Procurement + Compliance	Due-diligence documents
Travel expense	Reporting Manager	Expense claim + receipts
Asset disposal	IT/Facilities + Finance	Asset record + disposal approval

6. Travel, Communication and Social Media

6.1 Business travel

Business travel must be approved before booking unless an emergency exception applies. Employees should use approved travel channels and select reasonable options considering cost, safety, schedule, and business requirements.

6.2 Travel expenses

Eligible travel expenses may include transportation, accommodation, meals, local travel, and other approved business costs. Personal upgrades, entertainment, minibar purchases, and expenses for accompanying family members are not reimbursable unless specifically approved under a written company benefit or exception.

6.3 External communication

Only authorized spokespersons may make official statements on behalf of the company. Employees responding to customers, media, regulators, or public inquiries must follow the relevant communication and escalation process.

6.4 Social media

Employees may use personal social-media accounts, but they must not disclose confidential information, publish customer or employee data without authorization, misrepresent personal opinions as official company statements, or use company trademarks in a way that suggests unauthorized endorsement.

6.5 Recruitment and candidate information

Candidate resumes, contact details, interview feedback, compensation information, and assessment records must be handled confidentially and only for legitimate recruitment purposes. Candidate information must not be downloaded, copied, forwarded, or retained outside approved systems without authorization.

6.6 Customer and partner communications

Employees must provide accurate information to customers and partners. Commitments involving pricing, delivery timelines, contractual terms, regulatory claims, or technical specifications should be made only within the employee's authority and based on approved information.

Practical communication checklist

- Is the information accurate and approved?
- Does the recipient have a legitimate need to receive it?
- Does the communication contain confidential or personal information?
- Am I authorized to make this commitment or statement?
- Would the communication create a legal, regulatory, security, or reputational risk?

7. Grievance Handling, Reporting and Policy Administration

7.1 Raising a concern

Employees are encouraged to raise concerns promptly when they observe misconduct, safety risks, discrimination, harassment, fraud, conflicts of interest, data-security incidents, quality concerns, or other policy violations. Concerns may be raised with the reporting manager, Human Resources, Compliance, or another designated reporting channel.

7.2 Non-retaliation

The company prohibits retaliation against a person who raises a concern in good faith or participates honestly in an investigation. Retaliation concerns should be reported through the same escalation channels.

7.3 Investigation process

Reported concerns may be reviewed to determine whether an investigation is required. Investigations may involve interviews, document review, system records, and other appropriate evidence. Employees are expected to preserve relevant information and cooperate honestly.

7.4 Corrective action

Where a policy violation is substantiated, the company may take corrective action consistent with the seriousness of the matter, applicable law, employment terms, and internal procedures. Corrective actions may include coaching, retraining, process changes, formal disciplinary measures, recovery of unauthorized amounts, or other appropriate action.

7.5 Policy exceptions

Exceptions to this manual require documented approval from the policy owner or the authority specified in the relevant procedure. An informal verbal agreement does not automatically create a policy exception.

7.6 Policy review and ownership

Human Resources and Corporate Compliance are responsible for coordinating periodic review of this manual. Policy owners should review requirements when there are significant organizational, legal, regulatory, technology, or operational changes.

Quick reference: who to contact

Issue	Primary Contact
Employment, leave, workplace conduct	Human Resources
Quality or compliance concern	Quality / Compliance
Cybersecurity, phishing, access issue	Information Security / IT
Safety incident or near miss	EHS / Site Safety
Procurement or supplier issue	Procurement / Finance
Confidential misconduct concern	Compliance / Ethics Channel

End of document. This fictional policy manual is intentionally structured with distinct topics, entities, dates, rules, responsibilities, and tables to provide varied retrieval targets for a Spring AI RAG/vector-database exercise.